

Ed Sawyer's Resignation 'Helps' Dark

PHILADELPHIA (AP) — The resignation of Eddie Sawyer and the hiring of Gene Mauch to replace him as manager of the Philadelphia Phillies brought this comment from Al Dark:

"When Sawyer resigned, it was the greatest thing he ever did for me. Now I can come to the ballpark every day and concentrate on the game without somebody asking me, 'when are you going to take over the Phillies?'"

The veteran third baseman had been frequently mentioned as the eventual Phils' pilot since he was acquired from the Chicago Cubs in the off-season.

In the wake of rumors that one of the reasons for Sawyer's quitting was his inability to handle veteran ballplayers, Dark commented:

"I liked Eddie. . . if you couldn't play for Eddie, you just couldn't play, period."



Al Dark